Exp No: 11	**Deploying a Zoho Creator application from development to production environment.**

AIM:

To deploy a Zoho Creator application from the development environment to the production environment using the Environments feature, so that the users work only on the tested and stable version of the application.

ALGORITHM / PROCEDURE:

In Zoho Creator an application can be kept in separate **environments**: *Development* (the developer builds and changes the application), *Stage* (the application is tested with sample data before release) and *Production* (the live version used by the real users). The changes are moved from one environment to the next by the **Deploy** option. The application structure (forms, reports, pages and workflows) is deployed, but the records of the development environment are not moved to production. The Environments feature is available only in some paid plans, and the developer or the admin of the account can deploy.

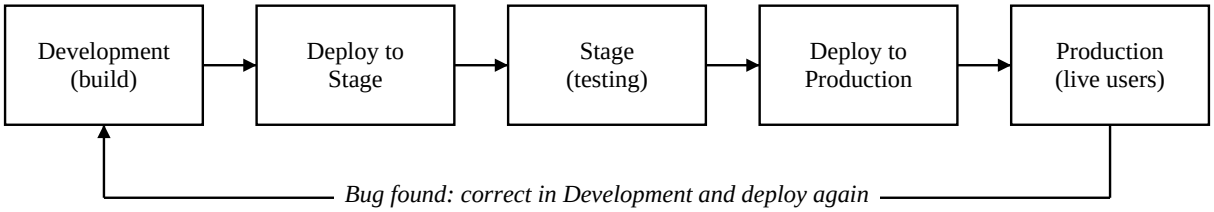
1. Log in to Zoho Creator and create an application named *Leave Management* with the forms Employee and Leave_Request, one report for each form and a workflow that sends a mail on submitting the leave request.
2. Check the environment switcher at the top of the application. The new application is created in the **Development** environment. Add a few test records and test all the forms and workflows here.
3. Go to **Settings** → **Environments** (or the Deploy option of the application) and click **Deploy to Stage**. Give a short description of the changes (the release note) and click Deploy.
4. Open the application in the **Stage** environment and do the user testing with the sample data. Check the roles, the mail workflow and the reports. If a bug is found, correct it in Development and deploy again.
5. When the testing is over, select **Deploy to Production** from the Stage environment, enter the release note and confirm the deployment.
6. Open the **Production** environment and check that all the forms, reports and workflows are present, and that the test records are not there because the data is not copied.
7. Try to edit a form directly in Production. The design changes are not allowed there, which shows that the live application is protected from the direct changes.
8. Make a small change in Development (for example, add the field *Reason* in Leave_Request), deploy it again through Stage to Production, and check that the old records of Production are not lost.
9. Note down the observations.

Note: the names of the menus may be slightly different in different versions of Creator. Take a backup of the production application before every deployment, and keep the values that differ

between the environments (like URLs and mail ids) in application settings and not as fixed values in the scripts.

DIAGRAM:

Fig 1: Deployment of a Zoho Creator application from Development to Production



RESULT:

Thus the Zoho Creator application was deployed from the Development environment through the Stage environment to the Production environment. The application structure was moved without the test data, the production application was protected from direct changes, and the later changes were released again using the same deployment steps.